

selling songs outright for 50 francs apiece.

In 1871, Fauré became a founder member of the Société Nationale de Musique, a body that was created by Saint-Saëns in order to promote modern French composers, and his music was celebrated in the cultivated salons of the Princesse de Polignac and Madame de Saint-Marceaux. Wider recognition eluded him, however, until late in his career.



THE OFFERTORY

This sketch of the second movement of the Requiem, the Offertory, is written in Gabriel Fauré's own hand.

Tremendous originality

Fauré's work was never truly avant-garde, but many of his critics found it challenging; even his most famous creation, the Requiem, was deemed insufficiently somber, and dubbed "a